

INNOVATION MARKETPLACE

Site's Guide

A practical user guide for students, groups and administrators

Student access

Product workflow

Admin control

Draft presentation edition - English guide

Innovation Management 2026

Purpose of the platform

Innovation Marketplace is a shared digital space where university groups present their innovations, publish product information and collect purchase-interest signals from fellow students. Administrators supervise voting, course editions, group records and exports.

1. PLATFORM OVERVIEW

What the site is designed to do

The site supports a complete classroom innovation workflow: groups prepare their product pages, students browse a shared catalog and signal whether they would consider buying a product, while the admin manages data quality and voting operations.

Core value

The platform turns a qualitative classroom activity into a structured, reusable digital experience with measurable demand signals.

User roles at a glance

Students Browse published products, open product details and express purchase interest while voting is open.	Group members Access the Group area with group name and Student ID, create the product profile, manage media and submit group update requests.
Admin Control voting, manage groups and Student IDs, review requests, manage course editions and export results.	Reusable course system The same platform can support future course editions without manually rebuilding the environment each year.

Main navigation areas

Area	Primary purpose
Homepage	Student sign-in and public access to group request flow.
Catalog	Shared listing of published products.
Leaderboard	Ranking of products by recorded purchase interest.
Group area	Product editing, media management and group update requests.
Admin area	Platform supervision, voting control and data operations.

2. STUDENT ACCESS

How a student enters the platform

Students are identified through two pieces of information: their group and their Student ID. This keeps the platform simple for the classroom context while allowing actions to remain associated with the correct group records.

1**Open the homepage**

Start from the public landing page of the platform.

2**Select the group**

Choose the group name from the list configured for the active course edition.

3**Enter the Student ID**

Insert the matriculation number associated with that group.

4**Access the available tools**

A valid student enters the platform and can use the catalog and, when relevant, the Group area.

If a group does not exist yet

A new group can submit a public group creation request. The admin reviews and approves or rejects it before the group becomes active.

Student-facing browsing

- Catalog: browse all published innovations in one shared marketplace.
- Product detail page: review title, price, description, images, category, badges and key features.
- Leaderboard: inspect the most desired products based on purchase-interest signals.

3. GROUP PRODUCT WORKFLOW

Create and prepare the product profile

Within the Group area, the product profile is designed to be flexible. Only the product name and price are mandatory; every other descriptive element can be enriched over time.

Field	Requirement	Use
Product name	Required	Identifies the innovation in catalog and product pages.
Price	Required	Displayed to help students evaluate purchase interest.
Short description	Optional	Useful for quick catalog scanning.
Full description	Optional	Provides richer context and value proposition.
Features	Optional	Highlights the main product capabilities.
Category and badges	Optional	Improve visual classification and discovery.

Media and publishing

Upload images Groups can add visual assets to support the product presentation.	Choose the cover image The first image may be used by default, but the group can select a different uploaded image as cover.
Remove incorrect images Uploaded images can be deleted if they were added by mistake or are no longer appropriate.	Publish the product Publishing makes the product visible in the public catalog and voting ecosystem.

Recommended group flow

Save the core profile first, upload images next, select the best cover and publish only when the page is presentation-ready.

4. STUDENT ENGAGEMENT AND GROUP CHANGES

Purchase-interest voting

When voting is open, students can indicate that they would consider buying a published product. The platform counts these signals and uses them for the product tally, leaderboard and admin analytics.

Voting open

Students can record purchase interest on published products.

Voting closed

New purchase-interest signals are frozen until the admin reopens voting.

Requesting a group update

Groups can send structured requests when their composition changes or when their name needs to be updated.

1

Open the Group area request form

Use the dedicated request section for group changes.

2

Describe the requested change

Propose a new group name, Student IDs to add and/or Student IDs to remove.

3

Submit for admin review

The request enters the admin review queue and remains pending until a decision is taken.

4

Review the status

The Group area displays pending requests and the latest reviewed outcome, including any admin note.

Why approval exists

The admin review step protects data quality and prevents accidental inconsistencies in group membership or course records.

5. ADMIN DASHBOARD

Control the activity from a single overview

The admin area centralizes platform supervision. It summarizes the active course edition, the live state of voting and the main operational counts.

Dashboard metric	Meaning
Voting status	Indicates whether purchase-interest voting is open or closed.
Published products	Counts the active products currently visible in the catalog.
Active students	Counts active Student IDs in active groups for the active edition.
Purchase-interest votes	Counts recorded purchase-interest signals.
Active groups	Counts active groups in the current edition.
Pending requests	Counts unresolved group creation and update requests.

Voting control

- Open voting when product review should begin.
- Close voting to freeze new purchase-interest responses.
- Use the exported result files after the voting period has ended.

Presentation tip

For a live classroom demonstration, keep voting closed during product setup, open it during the interaction phase and export results afterward.

Groups, Student IDs and requests

Create groups directly Add a confirmed group and its Student IDs from the admin interface.	Import from Excel Upload a spreadsheet to create many groups at once in the active edition.
Manage existing groups Rename groups, suspend them or delete them when needed.	Manage Student IDs Add, reactivate, deactivate or permanently delete Student IDs. Permanent deletion also removes associated votes.

Excel import expectations

Column	Expected value
Group Name	Name of the group. A blank cell can continue the previous group.
Student IDs	One Student ID per row.
Compatibility note The import tool supports the current English headers and is also designed to remain compatible with the previously used Italian spreadsheet structure.	

Reviewing group requests

- Review new group creation requests submitted from the public flow.
- Review update requests submitted by existing groups.
- Edit request details before approval when a correction is needed.
- Approve or reject requests and optionally store an admin note.
- Clear reviewed approval and rejection history when it is no longer needed.

7. COURSE EDITIONS AND EXPORTS

Keep the site reusable year after year

Course editions allow the same platform to support new academic cycles while keeping data organized. Only one edition is active at a time, but multiple editions may be stored.

Create an edition Define the edition name and academic year. Multiple editions can belong to the same academic year.	Activate an edition The chosen edition becomes the operational context for access, groups, requests and products.
Automatic safety Activating a different edition deactivates the previous one and keeps voting closed by default.	Delete with confirmation Permanent edition deletion requires the admin password and removes associated data.

Voting result exports

Export	Best for	Included content
CSV	Lightweight data transfer	Rank, product, group, category, price, interest count and interest rate.
Formatted XLSX	Presentable review and classroom reporting	A polished workbook with summary metrics and detailed voting result tables.

Suggested admin closeout
 At the end of the activity, close voting first, then download the formatted XLSX for presentation and the CSV for lightweight analysis.

8. RECOMMENDED CLASSROOM WORKFLOW

A complete end-to-end operating sequence

1

Before class

Create or activate the correct course edition. Add groups manually or import them from Excel.

2

Product preparation

Groups sign in, save product information, upload images and publish products.

3

Catalog review

Students browse the marketplace and inspect product detail pages.

4

Voting phase

The admin opens voting so purchase-interest signals can be recorded.

5

Results phase

The admin closes voting and downloads CSV or formatted XLSX exports.

Quick FAQ

Question	Answer
Can students see unpublished products?	No. Only published products appear in the catalog.
Can voting be paused?	Yes. The admin can close voting and reopen it later.
Can group records change after setup?	Yes. Changes can be made by the admin or requested by groups.
Can the same platform be reused in future years?	Yes. Course editions are built for reuse.
Are exports available?	Yes. Voting results can be exported in CSV and formatted XLSX.

9. ONE-PAGE CHEAT SHEET

Essential actions by role

Role	Essential actions
Student	Sign in - browse catalog - open product pages - express purchase interest when voting is open.
Group member	Sign in - create product - manage images - publish product - submit group update requests.
Admin	Sign in - control voting - manage groups and Student IDs - review requests - manage editions - export results.

Key site concepts

Active edition The current course cycle that powers access, catalog context and admin operations.	Published product A product visible to the wider student audience in the catalog.
Purchase interest A recorded signal that a student would consider buying the product.	Request review A controlled admin decision process for new groups or group changes.

Innovation Marketplace

A structured digital marketplace for classroom innovation projects.